



AFTER

New Orleans came under the military rule of Union General Benjamin Butler. His abrasive approach to controlling a hostile city provoked international controversy.

BRUTAL OCCUPATION

Butler **cracked down on demonstrations of support for the Confederacy** in the occupied city. Newspapers were censored and churchmen arrested for expressing Confederate sympathies in their services. When **William Mumford was hanged** for having torn down a Union flag at the time of the city's surrender, Jefferson Davis declared Butler himself a criminal worth hanging.

Moreover, from a Union point of view, **Butler outraged international opinion**. France's government denounced the arrest of champagne merchant Charles Heidsieck as a spy. Most damaging was Butler's General Order of May 15, 1862, stating that any woman who insulted Union soldiers "shall be ... treated as a woman of the town"—in other words, as a sex worker. **Butler succeeded in keeping order** and improving public health, **but he was removed** from command of the Department of the Gulf in late 1862.



BENJAMIN BUTLER